INCH POUND

A-A-58025A
10-MAR 2025
SUPERSEDING
A-A-58025
30-MAY 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FISHING KIT, SURVIVAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers the requirements for one style of survival fishing kit.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

2.1 General. This commercial item description delineates the design, construction, and equipment for a survival fishing kit.

2.2 Characteristics. The size and configuration dimensions for the container and winders shall be in accordance with (see figure 1 and figure 3) respectively.

2.3 Equipment. The required equipment shall be in accordance with this document in quantities as shown in (see table I) and suitable for its intended use.

2.4 Materials.

2.4.1 Hooks: All hooks shall be of steel, hollow ground with filed points. Hooks shall be ringed type and shall be tinned or plated, or of a corrosion resistant material. Hooks shall be tempered, tough, flexible, and resilient.

2.4.2 Leaders: Wire leaders shall be of stainless steel and shall be attached to snaps and swivels with not less than six (6) turns of wire. Nylon leaders shall be of clear or mist colored nylon and shall be Provided with a 0.625 inch, ±0.125 inch inside diameter end loop on one end.

2.4.3 Snaps and Swivels: Snaps shall be corrosion resistant steel, brass or bronze. Swivels shall be either brass or bronze.

2.4.4 Lines: Lines shall be the best commercial quality, monofilament (nylon), in lengths and test weight in accordance with (see table I, Items 9 and 10). Lines may be either camouflage or mist in color.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: AFLCMC/EZSS, 2145 Monahan Way, Area B, Wright-Patterson AFB, OH 45433-7017 or email to engineering.standards@us.af.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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2.4.5 Lures: Shall be of the spoon type.

2.4.6 Spoons: Spoons shall be of the single-blade egg-shaped, dished type with either fixed or free-swing hooks. The spoons shall be corrosion resistant steel with a gloss finish Each spoon shall, on the forward end, be provided with a swivel or split ring for attachment to the line. Spoons having free–swinging hooks shall have the hooks attached by means of a split ring through a hole in the rear of the blade. In fixed-hook spoons, the hook shall be attached to the spoon by eyelet or screw and shall be shaped to conform to the contour of the spoon.

2.4.7 Needles: Needles shall be drawn from steel of the best quality and properly tempered. Needle surfaces, including the eye section, shall be smooth and nickel plated.

2.4.8 Winders: Winders shall conform to the design and material of (see figure 3) or shall be of an equivalent commercial design.

2.5 Interchangeability. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be directly and completely interchangeable with each other with respect to installation and performance.

2.6 Fishing instruction booklet and illustration card.

2.6.1 Fishing instruction booklet: Fishing instructions shall be prepared in pamphlet form, on parchment paper, measuring approximately 2.625 x 2.625 inches, using a waterproof ink. Printing shall be on one side of the paper only. The booklet shall contain the information as shown in (see table III).

2.6.2 Illustration card, leader knots and hitches: An illustration card shall be prepared showing the illustrations and definitions from (see figure 2). The card shall be of waterproof material approximately 3.50 x 2.50 inches and shall be printed on both sides in waterproof ink or may be silk screened.

2.7 Kit assembly.

2.7.1 Preparation of Items: The items of (see table I), shall be packaged and prepared for packing into the kit as specified in (see table II).

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TABLE I. Equipment.

Item No.	Description.	Qty.
1.	Booklet, fishing instructions (see table III)	1 ea.
2.	Container, fishing kit (see figure 1)	1 ea.
3.	Hook, treble, size 1	2 ea.
4.	Hook, size 9/10, straight shank	2 ea.
5.	Hook, size 6	6 ea.
6.	Leader, wire, 0.011 inch diameter, 25 - 28 Pound test (with No. 3 snap on one end and No. 7 swivel on other end) 6 inch length	2 ea.
7.	Leader, Wire, 0.016 inch diameter, 58 - 62 pound test (with No. 4 snap on one end and No. 4 swivel on other end) 12 inch length	2 ea.
8.	Leader, nylon, 0.021 inch diameter, 14 - 16 pound test 4 foot length	4 ea.
9.	Line, nylon 18 - 20 pound test, 50 foot length	1 ea.
10.	Line, nylon 60 - 65 pound test, 50 foot length	1 ea.
11.	Mount assembly - vest type emergency fishing kit hook, (see figure 4)	1 ea.
1/ 12.	Needle, 1.500 inch-length	2 ea.
1/ 13.	Needle, 2.250 inch-length	2 ea.
14.	Needle, glovers', size 2/0	2 ea.
15.	Needle, sailmakers', size 15,	2 ea.
4/ 16.	Pin, safety, size No. 3	8 ea.
1/ 17.	Pad, cotton flannel cloth 2.750 inches square color - bright yellow	1 ea.
1/ 18.	Pad, cotton flannel, 2.750 inches square, color - bright red	1 ea.
2/ 19.	Lure, spoon, No. 6 hook, blade length 1.094 inches, width 0.469 inch, weight .05 ounce, polished finish	1 ea.
3/ 20.	Lure, spoon, fixed, No. 3/0 hook, blade length 2.312 inches, width 0.844 inch, weight, 0.40 ounce, polished finish (with stainless steel weedguard)	1 ea.
2/ 21.	Lure, spoon, free-swinging, No. 4 double hook, blade length 2.188 inches, width 0.812 inch, weight 0.25 ounce polished finish underneath, 2 red and 1 white stripe on top	1 ea.
22.	Snap-swivel, (No. 3 snap with No. 7 swivel)	2 ea.
23.	Winder, (see figure 3)	2 ea.
24.	Illustration card, leader knots and hitches (see figure 2)	1 ea.
25.	Blade, razor, (single edge, reinforced back)	1 ea.

1/ The tolerances on these items shall be ±0.031 inch.
2/ The tolerances on these items shall be ±0.01 ounce and ±0.031 inch.
3/ The tolerances on these items shall be ±0.05 ounce and ±0.031 inch.
4/ Overall length of 2 ±0.188 inches (50.8000 ±4.763 millimeters). Wire diameter of 0.043 inches (1.092 millimeters). The free end of the pin shall gradually taper to a sharp point.

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TABLE II.

Item No.	Preparation for assembly.
1, 2, 3, 4, 11, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 23, 24,	None
5	Insert in polyethylene envelope (0.4 MIL thickness) and attach to back of the Mounting Assembly card, Item 11.
6, 7, 8, and 22	Place in a polyethylene envelope (0.4 MIL thickness)
9 and 10	Wind on Winders, Item No. 23
12, 13, 14, and 15	Insert in pad, Item No. 17
16	Insert in pad, Item No. 18
25	Wrap in a protective paper envelope

NOTE: Each polyethylene envelope shall be closed by heat sealing

2.7.2 Packing of items: The components of the kit, after being prepared as specified above, shall be packed in the container in such a manner that there is a minimum possibility of any item being bent or crushed.

2.7.3 Identification of product: An identification marking label shall be placed on the exterior of the container lid. The identification marking label shall be marked by silk screen or with waterproof label and ink. The label shall reflect the information as follows:

a. Fishing Kit, Survival
b. National Stock Number (NSN)
c. CID NO.
d. Manufacturer's Identification
e. Contract or Order No. and Month/Year of Manufacture
f. List of Components and Quantity

2.7.4 Sealing of container: After the components have been packed therein, the container shall be sealed using an 18 inch length, by 0.750 inch width of commercial duct tape. The tape shall be applied around the perimeter of the container with an equal amount of tape on each side of the juncture of the two sections of the container.

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2.8 Performance:

2.8.1 Colors: All colors shall show good fastness when exposed to wetting and light. Enameled or lacquered surfaces shall not soften when exposed to temperatures of plus 158 ±3 degrees Fahrenheit for a period of one (1) hour.

2.8.2 Corrosion resistance: All plated, enameled, metals, treated-metal surfaces, and steels shall be made of or treated with proven corrosion resistant materials.

2.8.3 Workmanship: The kit shall be constructed and assembled in a thoroughly professional manner. The finished kit shall be clean and free from any defect that might affect the appearance or functionality of the kit.

2.9 Quality Assurance Provisions.

2.9.1 Responsibility for inspection: Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description (CID) where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

2.9.2 Testing: All tests required herein for the fishing kits are classified as quality conformance tests, for which necessary sampling techniques and methods of testing are specified in this section.

2.9.3 Sampling and examination of product: Kit(s) shall be selected at random and inspected to determine compliance with this CID. Kit(s) shall be examined to determine conformance with respect to material, coating, plating, painting, workmanship dimensions, and marking, and as otherwise specified by the procuring activity.

2.10 Preservation. Packaging, Packing, labeling, and marking.

2.10.1 Commercial: preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D3951, unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract or purchase order.

2.10.2 Military: The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking for military purposes, when required, shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

2.11 Intended use. The Fishing Kit covered by this CID is intended for use as one component of a military emergency survival kit.

2.11.1 Ordering data. Procurements documents should specify:

1. Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description (CID)
2. Levels of packaging and packing (see paragraph 2.10, 2.10.1 and 2.10.2)

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TABLE III.

FISHING INSTRUCTIONS

Of all the instructions which can be given to personnel, or a group personnel, facing the rigors of Nature with only their wits and a small amount of equipment, the most important is this:

KEEP YOUR HEAD

You have in this kit, sufficient equipment to keep you alive for an indefinite period. You can use your own good sense and these instructions to make yourself reasonably comfortable and safe. Your fishing kit is packaged in a lightweight metal container. The inside of the container lid is polished and can be used as a signal mirror. The bottom of the container can be used to cook small portions of the fish you catch. Use caution not to put it directly on hot coals as you may burn a hole in it. (Fish will cook in 3 to 5 minutes over medium heat). Be careful with every item of equipment you have; use and guard it carefully.

YOUR LIFE MAY DEPEND UPON IT!

The materials here can be used for fishing in either fresh or salt water. Many types of fish will take the lures, or the bait which can be used on the hooks included here. If you've never fished before - or if you have - these hints may help you.

ARTIFICIAL LURES

Your kit contains three different sized spoons which are excellent for trolling from a moving raft or boat. They also may be used with a pole or branch in a jigging action. In a stream, the current will keep the spoon moving, and will give it a life-like action. If you fish in still water, however, you must impart this action to the lure, through the use of line or rod. The spoon will take many types of fresh and salt-water fish. The large spoon can be fished in water where there are weeds if the weed guard wire is kept at an angle above the point of the hook. Often fish are found lurking in weedy spots-try them if open water does not bring results. You also have a red and white striped spoon which can be used in open water but not so effectively in other areas. In using either of these spoons be sure to attach one of the wire leaders to it by means of the snap and tie the other end of the leader firmly to the line.

There are also pieces of red and yellow flannel in the kit. Small strips of this material can be tied to the plain hooks in the box, and an excellent artificial lure will result. Such a lure must be moved through the water, to give the appearance of a brightly colored, wounded minnow. Either the red or yellow cloth, or a combination the two may be used. Be sure that the cloth is tied securely to the hook using a piece of your parachute shroud line as a tie. Other materials can be used to make artificial lures. A sliver of wood, tied to a hook and worked in the water, often looks very much like a small, injured fish, and will cause larger fish to strike.

LEADERS

You have both nylon and steel leaders in your kit. The nylon should be used for small fish. The steel leader should be used if you stand a chance of hooking larger fish, particularly those which have sharp teeth and might cut your line.

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HOOKS

Your plain hooks may be used for bait fishing, either from rafts, boat or shore. They may be baited with various types of worms and grubs, dug from the ground or found beneath rotting logs or in old stumps. If you are afloat on the ocean, small pieces of fish, cut from a fish you have caught with one of your artificial lures, often will be more successful than any other bait. A bite of biscuit, or meat from a bird will also serve this purpose. Always keep a piece of your last fish as bait for the next one.

In fishing with plain hooks, you may want to use the sinkers which are in the kit. It is seldom necessary to use these with artificial lures. It is not necessary to use the sinker unless you wish to troll your bait deep, from a moving boat, or unless the bait will not sink on its own weight. Wrap the sinker around the line or leader and bend the nipples into place to secure it. Be careful not to lose the clinch sinkers.

LINES

You have both heavy and light line. If you are trailing a lure behind you in open water, it probably will be wise to use the heavy line and the steel leader, for you're likely to hook into something big. If you are working small streams or lakes, and can see that the fish are fairly small, it is reasonably safe to use the lighter gear.

DON'T TIE THE LINE TO YOUR FINGER!!!

A big fish may cause you injury or may break the line.

Secure the end of the line to a grip in the raft, or to the belt loop in your trousers if you have no one else in the boat with you.

If there are two or more in the boat, let one person hold the end of the line, while the fisherman uses the body of the line to impart action to the lure or to hook the fish when they strike.

Sometimes, when fishing with meat or similar bait, it is necessary to let the fish take the bait in his mouth before you give a sharp tug on the line to set the hook. With artificial lures, set the hook as soon as you feel the strike.

Try for small rather than large fish. You have some idea of the-strength of the line. If the fish is so large that you are afraid, it'll break the tackle if you try to pull it straight into the boat or shore, feed it a little line through your fingers, always keeping a steady pressure on the line. The fish will soon tire, and you can bring it in easily. Watch for schools of feeding fish. Often flocks of gulls, diving into the water, will indicate the presence of such a school. Small fish jumping out of the water are another indication. Get as near to the school as possible and stay with it if you can.

In a stream, the upper end of the pools will most likely give the best results. Feeding fish gather there to grab the floating food as it enters the hole. Work the spoons, or baits in these spots. The lower end of holes also is often productive. Watch the water carefully. Note where fish are feeding, then fish there. Some fish are easily alarmed and will not strike if they see you. Be careful in approaching a pool. Don't disturb the water or cause any more disturbance than necessary. Some fish, on the other hand, are not afraid and will strike near the boat or near the feet of the fisherman. This is particularly true of salt-water species.

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In addition to the equipment named You have two treble hooks. Sometimes you can see fish in clear water. By attaching one of these treble hooks to one of the wire leaders, by means of the snap and tying the leader to your heavy line, you can make a rig that can be used to snag a fish. Probably it will help to use one or more of the sinkers on your line or leader fairly near the hook. This will give you added weight and help you to throw the line well past the fish so it will sink over it. If it is given a quick jerk when this occurs, you have a good chance of snagging it. You also have one large hook. This can be tied to a pole, using some of your parachute shroud line, and used as a gig to snag fish. It can also be used, if you hook an exceptionally heavy fish, to help in landing it.

You also have two extra snap swivels. Those can be used with one of your nylon leaders and the larger spoons if you find that the fish you are catching do not have sharp teeth.

Here are a few more hints on landing fish. On bringing in fish of the bass family if you are on shore, draw the fish up slowly and easily to the bank until he is **HALFWAY** out of the water. Usually, these fish will remain quiet, and you can pick them up quite easily. Pike and fish of this type having large protruding eyes can be landed by grasping them firmly with the thumb and middle finger by the eyes. If you are fishing from a boat or raft do not try to bring too large a fish in with you unless it has been knocked insensible. The outdoors is friendly, **DON'T BE AFRAID OF IT!** Nature will give you food and drink, warmth and cover, if You will take advantage of all it offers.

Shellfish along the shores of lakes, streams, or oceans are edible. Crayfish and mussels in fresh water, all sorts of shellfish on saltwater beaches, can be caught by hand. They are nourishing either raw or cooked. Often the presence of shellfish can be noted from small air-holes in the sand. **DIG'EM OUT!**

Bird's eggs are good; so are the birds. Sea snakes are not good for food. Eels, on the other hand, are. The snakes have scales; the eels do not. Only three kinds of fish are dangerous to eat. If a fish has a large beak like a parrot's, use it for bait but don't eat it. The other two poisonous varieties swell up like balloons if you scratch their bellies.

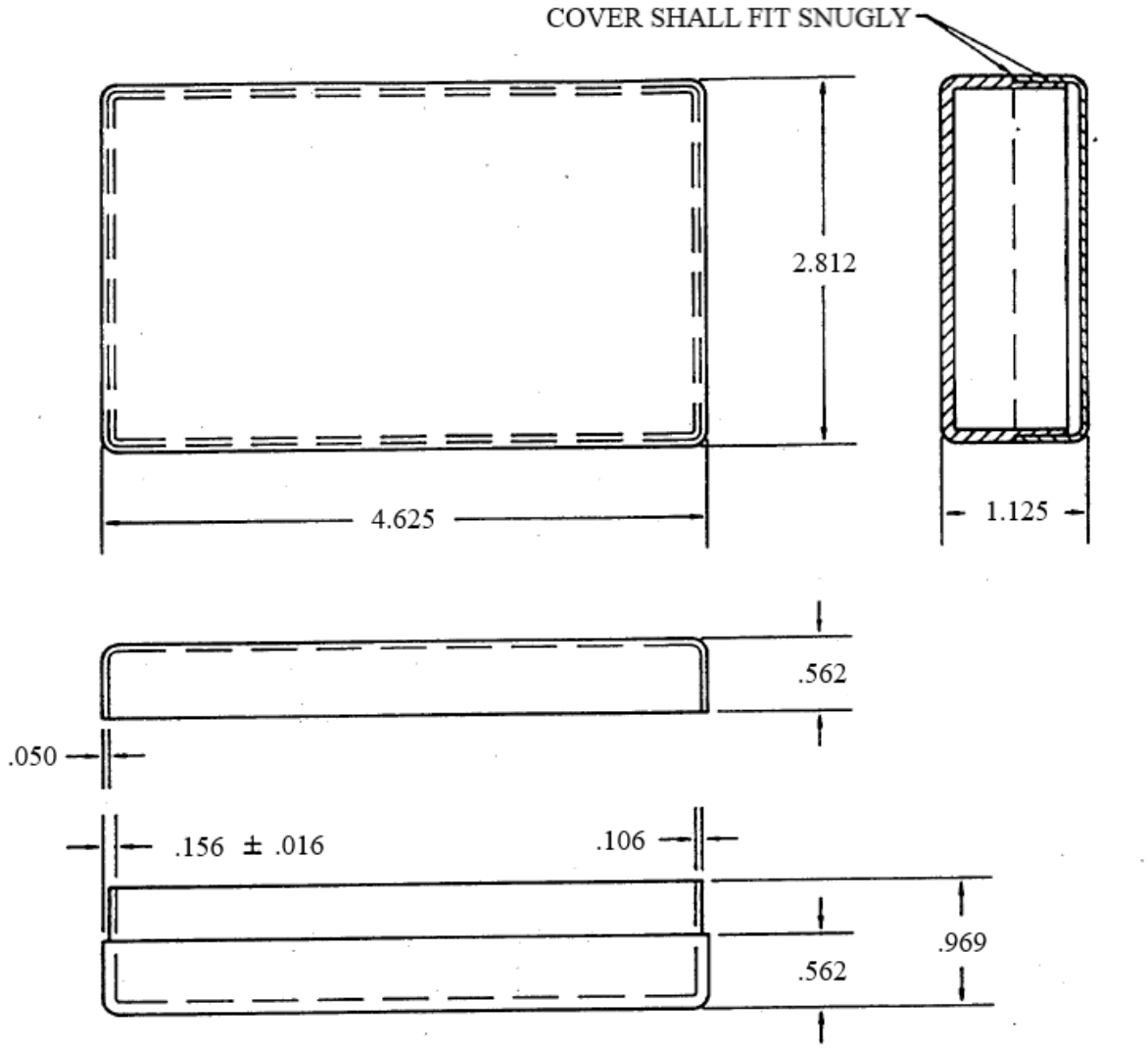
In the event clothing or other equipment must be repaired you should utilize the needles and parachute shroud line and safety pins.

ABOVE ALL-KEEP YOUR HEAD!!

Native tribes lived for generations in the open air, taking their living from nature. You can do the same. It may be tough and unpleasant - but you'll make the grade if you don't get excited and waste your energy. Make the most of every opportunity. Keep cool - and you will come out of your experience a better person.

BEST OF LUCK, AND REMEMBER THAT COURAGE ALONE HAS WON MANY A BATTLE.

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MATERIALS: Aluminum or another corrosion resistant metal that is suitable to cook in shall be used for the container.
The container shall have a reflective inner lid that can be used as a signal mirror.

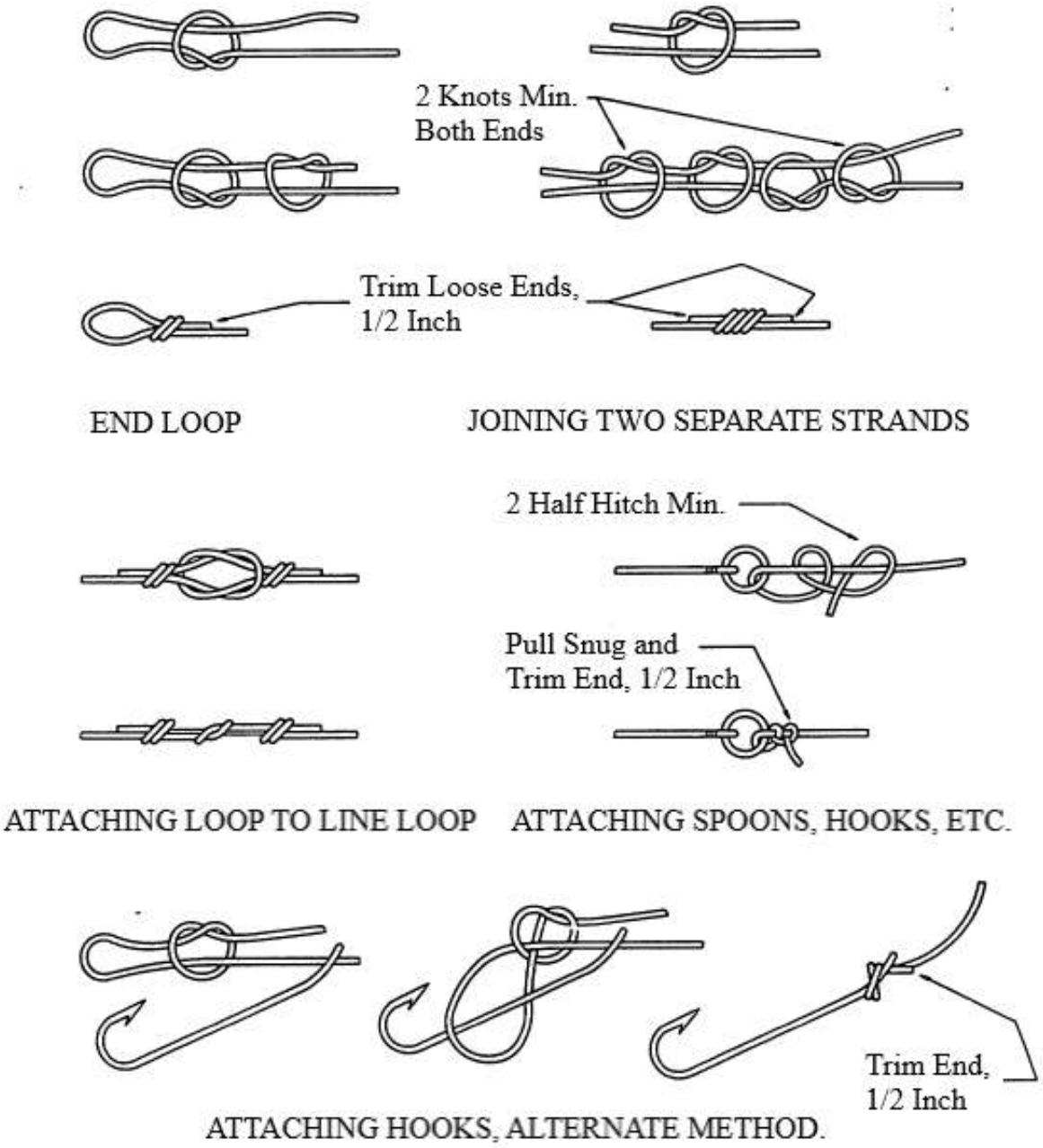
DIMENSIONS: Are in inches unless otherwise specified
i.e.: 4.625 x 2.812 x 1.125.

TOLERANCES: Above dimension tolerances are plus (+) or minus (–) 1/8 inch (.125) unless otherwise specified.

NOTE: The cover may be hinged to obtain a snug fit to the base

Figure 1. Container, Fishing Kit

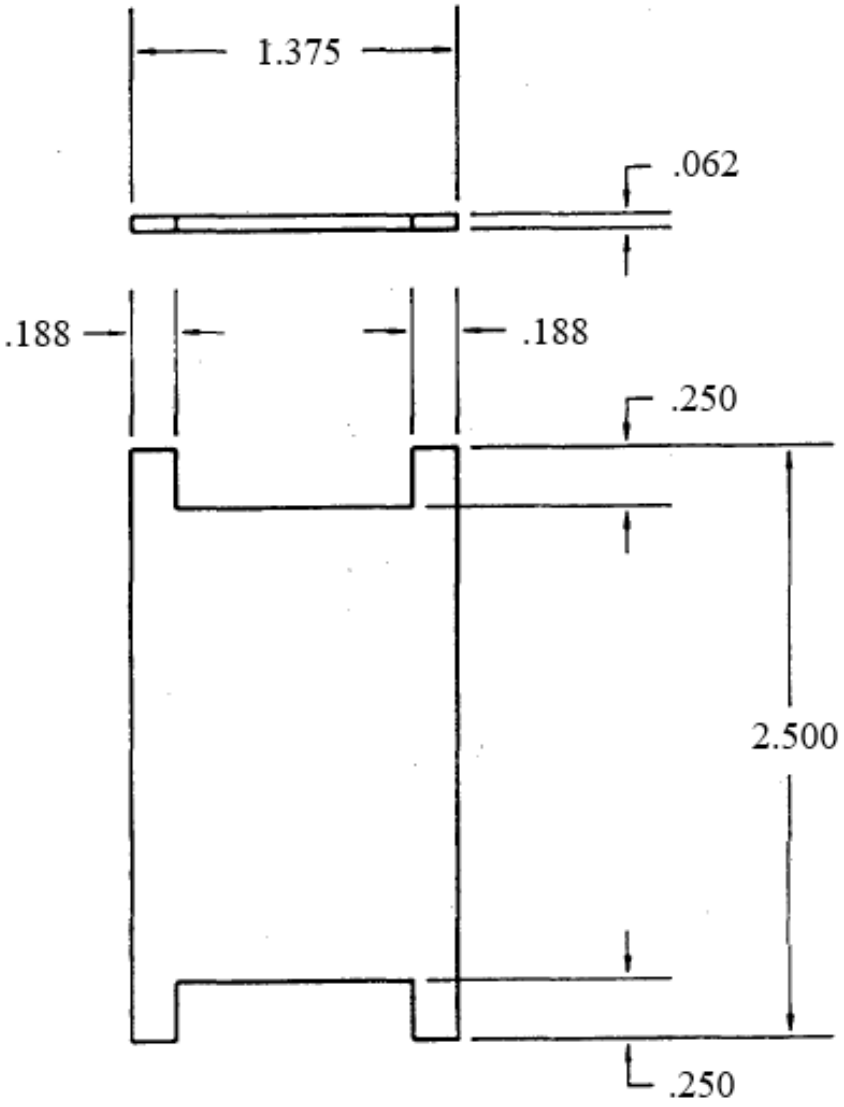
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WARNING: Always pull loose end(s) of knot tight to prevent loss of equipment.

Figure 2. Card – leader knots and hitches

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MATERIAL: Packing, Fiber Hard Sheet.

MATERIAL - PACKING, shall be composed of pure cellulose free from any appreciable amount of chloride, zinc, or mineral matter. It shall be clean hard, and straight, with smooth surfaces uniform in texture, density, physical characteristics thickness and color. Color shall be "Gray" or a "Natural Color". Packing shall be furnished in but one grade, known commercially as "B.H." or "BONEHARD". The "Brinell Hardness" shall be not less than 15.

Dimensions are in Inches unless otherwise specified.

Tolerances: ±0.031 unless otherwise specified.

Figure 3. Winder

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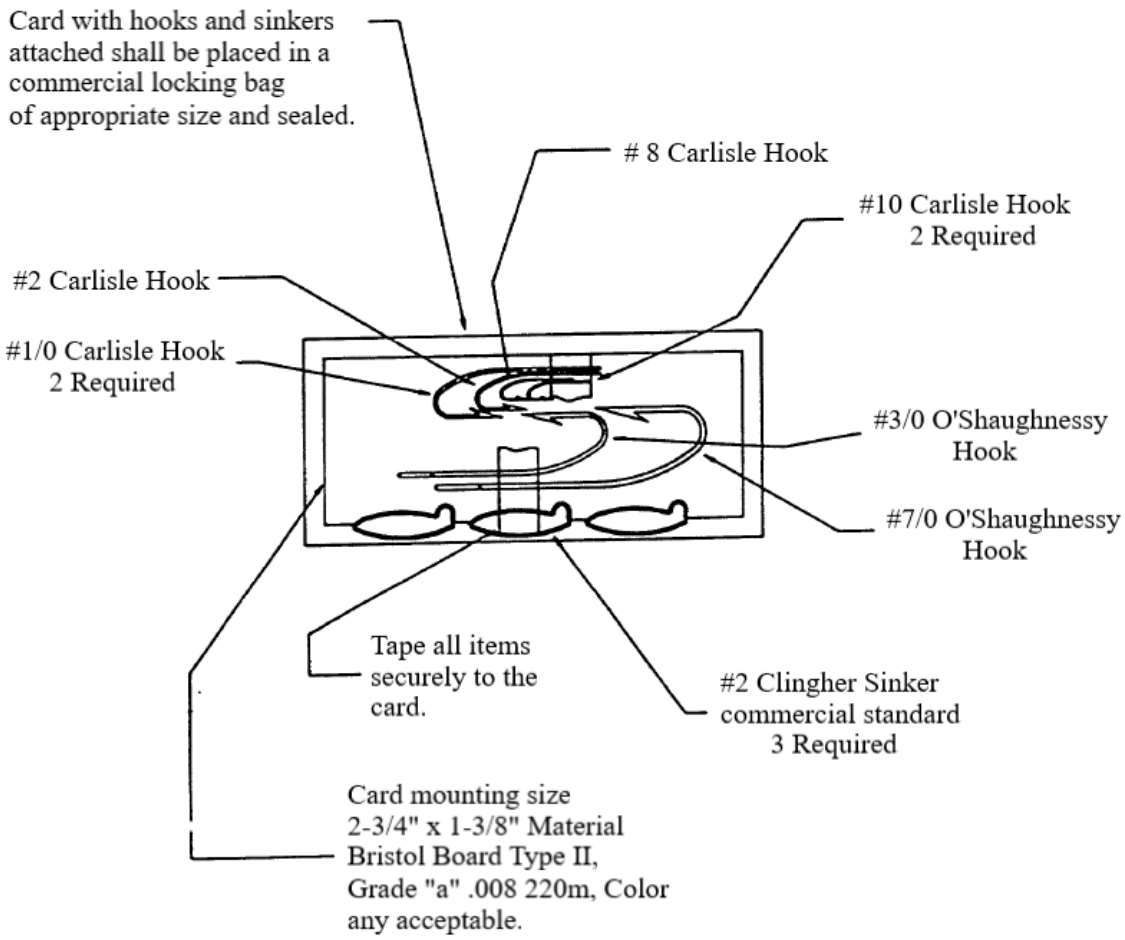


Figure 4. Emergency Fishing Kit

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3. PACKAGING.

3.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

4. NOTES.

4.1 Source of documents.

4.1.1 ASTM documents. Copies of ASTM documents may be obtained from the ASTM International, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, PO Box C700, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959, or online at https://www.astm.org/.

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